D06 · Logistics Governance & Analytics

04 · Customer service integration: order management & delivery promises

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1 WHAT IT IS

Customer service integration connects order management, available-to-promise and logistics execution so that the delivery date given to the customer is one the network can actually meet — and the customer hears about problems before they ask.

2 WHY IT MATTERS

Broken delivery promises usually start inside the company: inventory data that is late, lead times that are optimistic, warehouse releases that miss the cut-off. **Fixing the promise process is often worth more than adding carrier capacity.** And communication changes perception: a customer warned early experiences a managed exception, not a failure.

3 HOW IT IS DONE

1. **Make ATP real-time and complete.** Include in-transit, quality holds and reservations; no promises on stale data.
2. **Use actual lead times.** Update carrier and warehouse lead times from measured performance.
3. **Enforce cut-offs and priorities.** Clear warehouse release rules aligned with the promise.
4. **Notify proactively.** Automatic alerts to customer service and customers when an order is at risk.

IN PRACTICE

Make ATP real

Promises based on delayed or incomplete inventory data will always generate avoidable failures.

Communicate delays before the customer has to ask

Proactive notification converts many potential complaints into managed exceptions.

Align commercial promise rules with logistics capability

Sales incentives that reward aggressive dates without regard to feasibility create systemic failure.

ILLUSTRATIVE CASE

Illustrative case built from typical industry values — not data from a specific company.

Illustrative case — B2B distributor with 88.2% OTIF (11.8% promise failures)

Root Cause of Promise Failure	% of Failures	Corrective Focus
Incorrect ATP (promised unavailable stock)	34%	Real-time WMS–ATP integration
Underestimated carrier lead time	28%	Update lead-time master with actuals
Late warehouse dispatch	22%	Cut-off discipline + prioritization rules
In-transit carrier delay	16%	Control tower + proactive communication

Result: 84% of failures had internal process roots. Focusing on ATP accuracy and dispatch discipline produced larger OTIF gains than further pressure on carriers alone.

HOW IT IS MEASURED

Delivery Promise Accuracy %

(Orders delivered on the promised date and time / Orders with a delivery promise) × 100

Benchmark: >95% B2B · >92% for ambitious e-commerce promises

Order Cycle Time

Elapsed time from order capture to confirmed delivery

Benchmark: Track by channel; reduction without loss of Perfect Order Rate is the goal

WHAT YOU WOULD USE

Order & Promise Management

SAP S/4HANA aATP + Order Management — Advanced available-to-promise tightly integrated with inventory and transportation.

Manhattan Active Omni / other OMS platforms — Strong for complex omnichannel promise and allocation scenarios.

4 SO WHAT

Promise only what the network can deliver. Real-time ATP, measured lead times, disciplined cut-offs and proactive notifications turn service from apology into reliability.

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